Grateful & Grounded Kids

FAMILY HANDOUT

CHORES + AGE-APPROPRIATE WORK

Age-Appropriate Chores for Kids

Check off what your child already owns. Circle the next one or two to teach.

Ages 3-4	Ages 5-6	Ages 7-8
☐ Pick up toys and books	☐ Make their bed	☐ Take care of personal hygiene
☐ Put dirty clothes in a hamper	☐ Get dressed	☐ Organize their room
☐ Help dress themselves (e.g., socks)	☐ Brush teeth and hair	☐ Put away laundry
☐ Wipe down surfaces	☐ Put away their own shoes and coat	☐ Sweep floors
☐ Set the table	☐ Empty small trash cans	☐ Help with dusting
☐ Water plants	☐ Dust furniture	☐ Load and unload the dishwasher
☐ Feed pets with pre-portioned food	☐ Help set the table	☐ Wipe counters
☐ Dust low surfaces with a duster or cloth	☐ Clear their own dishes	☐ Help take out the trash
☐ Help stir or mix ingredients	☐ Help prepare simple meals	☐ Wash dishes by hand
☐ Carry non-breakable items to the table	☐ Help pull weeds	☐ Put away groceries

Ages 9-10	Ages 11-12	Ages 13-14
☐ Prepare simple meals (e.g., sandwiches)	☐ Manage their schedule	☐ Do their own laundry
☐ Follow basic recipes	☐ Vacuum or mop floors	☐ Budget and track allowance or earnings
☐ Load and unload the dishwasher	☐ Wash, dry, fold, and put away laundry	☐ Grocery shop
☐ Wash and dry dishes	☐ Clean windows and mirrors	☐ Pack school lunches
☐ Make shopping lists	☐ Dust furniture, baseboards, and fans	☐ Wash cars
☐ Rake leaves, shovel snow, or pull weeds	☐ Empty and clean trash cans	☐ Help with gardening tasks
☐ Mow the lawn with supervision	☐ Clean bathrooms	☐ Assist with minor outdoor repairs
☐ Water plants or gardens	☐ Organize common areas	☐ Babysit younger siblings
☐ Help wash and detail the car	☐ Clean kitchen counters and table	☐ Learn basic home maintenance skills
☐ Start a load of laundry	☐ Water plants and prune small shrubs	☐ Run nearby errands

HOW TO USE THIS LIST

- **Start where they are.** Add one new chore at a time, not ten.
- **Teach it before you expect it.** Show them, do it together, then watch them do it on their own.
- **Keep the younger lists.** A 12-year-old still makes their bed and clears their dishes.
- **Let responsibility lead.** As your child owns more of the work, extend more of the privileges. Privilege without responsibility produces entitlement.